

Appendix B

Acceptable Abbreviations for Patient Care Documentation

AAA	abdominal aortic aneurysm
ACLS	Advanced Cardiac Life Support
AED	automatic external defibrillator
Afib	atrial fibrillation
AICD	automatic internal cardio-defibrillator
AIDS	acquired immune deficiency syndrome
AMS	altered mental status
AMI	acute myocardial infarction
A&O	alert and oriented
A&O x 1	alert and oriented to person
A&O x 2	alert and oriented to person and place
A&O x 3	alert and oriented to person, place, and time
A&O x 4	alert and oriented to person, place, time, and event
APGAR	appearance, pulse, grimace, activity, respirations
APS	Adult Protective Services
ARDS	adult respiratory distress syndrome
ASA	aspirin
ASAP	as soon as possible
AV	atrioventricular
AVPU	Alert, Verbal, Painful, Unconscious
BBB	bundle branch block
BCLS	basic cardiac life support
BLS	basic life support
bm or BM	bowel movement
BP	blood pressure
bpm	beats per minute or breaths per minute
BSA	body surface area
BSI	body substance isolation
BVM	bag valve mask
C#	cervical vertebrae number 1-7

CA	cancer
CABG	coronary artery bypass graft
CAD	coronary artery disease
CC	chief complaint
CHF	congestive heart failure
cm	centimeter
CMS	circulation, motion, sensation
CNS	central nervous system
c/o or C/O	complains of
COPD	chronic obstructive pulmonary disease
CP	chest pain
CPAP	continuous positive airway pressure
CPR	cardiopulmonary resuscitation
CPS	Child Protective Services
CSF	cerebrospinal fluid
C-spine	cervical spine
CVA	cerebrovascular accident
D50	50% dextrose
d/c	discontinue
defib	defibrillate
DFS	Department of Family Services
DIC	disseminated intravascular coagulation
DJD	degenerative joint disease
DKA	diabetic ketoacidosis
DM	diabetes mellitus
DNR	Do Not Resuscitate
DOA	dead on arrival
DOB	date of birth
DOS	dead on scene
Dr.	doctor
DTs	delirium tremens
DVT	deep vein thrombosis
Dx	diagnosis
ECG or EKG	electrocardiogram
ED	emergency department
EEG	electroencephalogram
EJ	external jugular
ET	endotracheal
ETT	endotracheal tube
ETA	estimated time of arrival
ETCO2	end tidal carbon dioxide

ETOH	ethanol or alcohol
fib	fibrillation
ft	feet or foot (as in measurement)
F/U	follow-up
fx or FX	fracture
G	gravida
GCS	Glasgow Coma Scale
GI	gastrointestinal
GU	genitourinary
GSW	gunshot wound
GYN	gynecology
H&P	history and physical
H/A or HA	headache
Haz-Mat	hazardous material
HCTZ	hydrochlorothiazide
HEENT	head, eyes, ears, nose, throat
HIV	human immunodeficiency virus
h/o or H/O	history of
HR	heart rate
hr	hour
ht	height
HTN	hypertension
Hx	history
ICD	implantable cardioverter-defibrillator
ICP	intracranial pressure
IDDM	insulin dependent diabetes mellitus
IM	intramuscular
IO	intraosseous
irreg	irregular
IV	intravenous
IVDA	intravenous drug abuse
IVP	intravenous push
J	joule
JVD	jugular venous distention
K+	potassium
Kg	kilogram
KVO	keep vein open
L	left
L	liter
L#	lumbar vertebrae #1-5
lac	laceration
LAD	left anterior descending artery

LLE	left lower extremity
LLQ	left lower quadrant
LMP	last menstrual period
LOC	level of consciousness or loss of consciousness
LR	Lactated Ringers
LUE	left upper extremity
LUQ	left upper quadrant
LZ	landing zone
max	maximal or maximum
mcg	microgram
MCI	multiple casualty incident
MDI	metered dose inhaler
mEq	milliequivalent
mg	milligram
MI	myocardial infarction
min	minute
ml / mL	milliliter
mm	millimeter
mmHg	millimeters of mercury
MOI	mechanism of injury
MRI	magnetic resonance imaging
MRSA	methicillin resistant staphylococcus aureus
MS	multiple sclerosis
MVC	motor vehicle crash
MVPed	motor vehicle vs pedestrian
Na	sodium
NAD	no acute distress
NC or N/C	nasal cannula
NKA	no known allergies
NKDA	no known drug allergies
NPO	nothing by mouth
NRB	non-rebreather mask
NS	normal saline
NSR	normal sinus rhythm
NSTEMI	non-ST elevation myocardial infarction
NT	nasotracheal
NTG	nitroglycerin
N/V	nausea and vomiting
N/V/D	nausea, vomiting, and diarrhea
O2	oxygen
OB	obstetrical

OTC	over the counter
oz	ounce
PAC	premature atrial contraction
PCP	primary care physician
PE	pulmonary embolism
PEA	pulseless electrical activity
ped or Ped	pedestrian
pedi	pediatric
PERRLA	pupils equal, round, react to light and accommodation
PERRL	pupils equal, round, reactive to light
PMHx	past medical history
PID	pelvic inflammatory disease
PJC	premature junctional contraction
PMS	premenstrual syndrome
po or PO	orally / by mouth
POV	privately owned vehicle
PPE	personal protective equipment
PRN or prn	as needed
pt	patient
PTA	prior to arrival
psych	psychiatric
PVC	premature ventricular contraction
q or Q	every
R or rt	right
RA	room air
reg	regular
RLE	right lower extremity
RLQ	right lower quadrant
r/o or R/O	rule out
ROM	range of motion
ROSC	return of spontaneous circulation
RR	respiratory rate
RUE	right upper extremity
RUL	right upper lobe
RUQ	right upper quadrant
Rx	prescription / therapy / treatment
sat or Sat	saturation
SIDS	Sudden Infant Death Syndrome

SL	sublingual
COGS	clinical operating guidelines
SaO ₂	oxygen saturation
SOB	short of breath or shortness of breath
S/P	status post
SROM	spontaneous rupture of membranes
s/s	signs and symptoms
STD	sexually transmitted disease
STEMI	ST-elevation myocardial infarction
SC or SQ	subcutaneous
SVT	supraventricular tachycardia
sync	synchronized
sz or Sz	seizure
T#	thoracic vertebrae 1-12
T or temp	temperature
TB	tuberculosis
TBSA	total body surface area
Tbsp	tablespoon
TIA	transient ischemic attack
TKO	to keep open
trach	tracheostomy
tsp	teaspoon
tx / Tx	traction / therapy / treatment / transfer
UE	upper extremity
unk	unknown
URI	upper respiratory infection
UTI	urinary tract infection
Vfib or VF	ventricular fibrillation
vs.	versus
VS	vital signs
VT	ventricular tachycardia
w/	with
WMD	weapons of mass destruction

wnl / WNL	within normal limits
w/o	without
x	times
yrs	years
y/o	years old
@	at
Δ	change
↑	increase(d)
↓	decrease(d)
<	less than
>	greater than
°	hours or degree
Ø	negative
+	plus or positive
-	minus or negative
≈	approximately
≠	not equal
=	equal
♀	female
♂	male
&	and